Purpose

To make sure that a temperature of sealing is kept constant and careful external visual examination of pouches and their seals is the primary means of detecting pouch defects.

Scope

This document covers the procedures for sealing temperature Verification and closed pouch visual seal inspection on seal width, seal integrity and delamination of the pouch on incoming pouch and retorted pouch.

Responsibility

- It is the responsibility of Management to ensure that this procedure is communicated, understood and adhered to by all relevant personnel.
- The Factory Manager will represent Management in this regard.
- Upon commencement of duties all employees involved in inspection of the sealing and seal defects must be made aware of this procedure through induction training.

Procedure

The sealing temperature range is set at 165-180°C. The sealers are allowed to heat up before sealing commences. The temperature of the sealer is recorded on form SF 02 on the interval of 1 hour during production.

During production 5 units will be picked every after 15 minutes as it is coming from the inline check weigh to the round table. The closed pouch is being inspected (SF 03) for several steps as follows:

- Carefully examine the edges of each seal for any evidence of product in the seal area. No product (oil, etc.) should be visible,
- measure the width of the seals, at three locations: Left edge; Centre; Right edge, along the seal to ensure that they meet the required minimum seal width of 5 mm (3 mm and greater as per Canadian food Inspection Agency Specification); and examine the seals by grasping the unsealed area of the laminate and exerting a steady pressure.

- Observe the package and pouch seals for signs of seal defects, e,g. creep or delamination.
- The pouch is checked for visual defects of concern include misaligned seals, flex cracking, product contamination of the seal, non-bonding, seal creep and delamination.
- If the reading of the temperature gauge is not corresponding with our standards, corrective action need to be taken first and put on hold all product that was sealed since the previous inspection check, and then take appropriate actions to bring the temperature into specification.

Visual examinations will also be done after retorting since pouches can be damage during the retorting, unloading, storage and packaging stages due to shingling of the pouches and rough handling.

Purpose

The purpose of these procedures is to ensure that pressure tests is conducted safely and effectively. A static load burst test may be used to determine the burst strength of a pouch as an indication of correct heat sealing conditions.

Scope

Visual inspection and external seal measurements will be done to provide an initial assessment of seal integrity. The pouch integrity test and width measurement is useful in locating and diagnosing pouch faults.

Responsibility

- It is the responsibility of Management to ensure that this procedure is communicated, understood and adhered to by all relevant personnel.
- The Factory Manager will represent Management in this regard.
- Upon commencement of duties all employees involved in the receiving and inspection of incoming products and retorted pouch must be made aware of this procedure through induction training.

Procedures

- After retorting 6 pouch samples per batch code are drawn for bursting pressure testing.
- A pressure force is exerted on the pouch. Each pouch is expected to be able to withstand a force equal to or greater than 200 KPa.
- The operator records the force at which the pouch seal fails, SF 04.
- The width of the seal (≥5 mm) (greater than 3mm in the Canadian Food Inspection agency) before the bursting pressure testing, is also inspected and recorded.
- In case were a sample does not conform to our standards, the whole consignment batch is isolated and put on hold. A re-inspection on 12 samples is conducted to test for compliance.
- If a second re-inspection fails, Corrective action process is initiated.

Purpose To ensure the food safety system is working to prevent, control or significantly reduce public health hazards.

Scope Establishing a program to verify that the x ray is working. Establishing a program to verify that all sealed pouches are screened for metals, ceramic, glass through the x-ray.

Responsibility

- It is the responsibility of Management to ensure that this procedure is communicated, understood and adhered to by all relevant personnel.
- The SHEQ Assurance Manager will represent Management in this regard.
- Upon commencement of duties Quality Controllers involved in inspection of the x ray detector must be made aware of this procedure through induction training.

Procedure

The metal detector must be properly verified to ensure its effectiveness. At African Deli, the x ray detector verification checks will be done before a production lot and after 1 hours throughout the production run and during break down (SF 05).

- This entails passing the test sticks containing stainless steel ball, glass ball and ceramic balls of different sizes, through the detector and confirming that, the x ray recognizes them on the first pass.

Test Piece	Size
Glass Ball	1.0mm, 1.5mm, 2.0mm
Ceramic Ball	1.0mm, 1.5mm, 2.0mm
SUS 304 Ball	0.4mm, 0.7mm, 0.8mm, 1.0mm, 1.2mm, 1.5mm

- If the detector does not recognize the test pieces during verification, corrective actions need to be taken on all products that was scanned since the previous successful verification check and then take appropriate actions to bring the metal detector into specification.
- All product placed on hold must be rescreened through a properly operating x ray detector. This can be done either on-line or off-line.
- In case of rejected products, further investigation of the content is done.
- All sealed pouches must run through the x ray detector for screening before retorting.

Purpose

To evaluate the product retorting period and evaluate its efficient in terms of time, temperature and pressure used to adequately destroy harmful microorganisms.

Scope

To achieve and verify uniform heating conditions in a retort that ensure product in all areas of the retort receive the scheduled process. Heat transfer distribution studies with temperature measuring devices mounted inside product simulators or product-filled containers may be used to determine heating variations within the retort and to identify the retort cool zone(s) used for process development activities.

Responsibility

- It is the responsibility of Management to ensure that this procedure is communicated, understood and adhered to by all relevant personnel.
- The factory Manager will represent Management in this regard.
- Upon commencement of duties all employees involved in inspection of the retort process must be made aware of this procedure through induction training.

Procedure

- The product on the trolley is inspected by Quality Controller and the information is recorded on form SF 07.
- The Ingoing Temperature is taken and retort tape is placed and recorded on the form 08 SF01. The product is retorted at temperature [redacted] for Beef Tripe [redacted] 119.5 for 40 minutes Chicken Livers 425g. Parameters such as temperature, Pressure and time is monitored for every retorted batch and recorded on form SF 06.
- Temperature and pressure verification checks need to be conducted during the retort process of each retort cycle (SF 08).

Retort Condition of Beef Tripe (African Deli)

Inner-core Temperature	Cooking Temperature	Dwell Time	Cooking Time	Minimum F0 value
[redacted]				

Chicken Gizzards 375g (African Deli)

Inner-core Temperature	Cooking Temperature	Dwell Time	Cooking Time	Minimum F0 value
[redacted]				

Chicken Livers 375g (African Deli)

Inner-core temperature	Cooking temperature	Dwell time	Cooking time	Minimum F0 value
[redacted]				

Chicken Livers 425g (Goshen Foods)

Inner-core temperature	Cooking temperature	Dwell time	Cooking time	Minimum F0 value
119°C	119.5°C	68 minutes	40 minutes	10

- If the readings and the retort chart are not conforming with our standards, corrective actions need to be taken. First, place "on hold" sticker on all product that was retorted for that batch, and the retorting records results shall be send to an independent certified party for further verifications. If the retort tape does not change colour from white to black stripes, or the ink-jet on the pouch does not change from black to blue, the product can be re-retorted at sufficient time and temperature to complete the retort cycle.
- When a deviation is detected in progress, the affected product need not be held if the corrective action executed is to apply the original scheduled process, implement an alternate process, or reprocess in accordance with a process recommended in

writing from a processing authority. After the corrective action is applied, the processor must assure the application has been satisfactorily implemented and documented on batch records and in the deviation file.